



Making the Big Leap

If you are thinking about starting your own business, developing your idea in your spare time is a good way to start. Then weigh the pros and cons to understand your motivation for starting something new.

Working for yourself or others?

It is crucial not to underestimate the hard work involved in running a business. Instead of having one role, business owners often take on multiple responsibilities—from producing a product or performing a service to carrying out all the administrative tasks as well as going out and selling the idea. Although you may no longer have a boss to answer to, your working hours may be much longer, especially at the start.

As a business owner, you have more responsibilities and need to invest more in your future. You will take more risks and feel more pressure running your own business, but the potential for success is often greater than working for an existing company. Running your own business will mean you have more control and flexibility.

Be clear about your motivations for starting up a

Considering your options

Remember that paid employment brings many benefits, whereas being your own boss can be stressful and financially risky. Weigh your options carefully before you reach a balanced decision.



Pros

- › **Financial security** comes from a regular weekly or monthly paycheck.
- › **Sickness and vacation pay** bring more consistent income.
- › **Sense of belonging** comes from working with others toward a common cause.
- › **Investment in your development** and training is paid for by employers.
- › **Opportunities to build** experience and develop new skills are available.

THEIR COMPANY

Cons

- › **Earnings are limited** depending on the company's pay policy.
- › **Your hard work** helps achieve another person's dreams rather than your own.
- › **Office politics** can be frustrating.
- › **Time and money** is spent on commuting to a workplace chosen by the company.
- › **Lack of flexibility** in work hours and conditions can be problematic.